

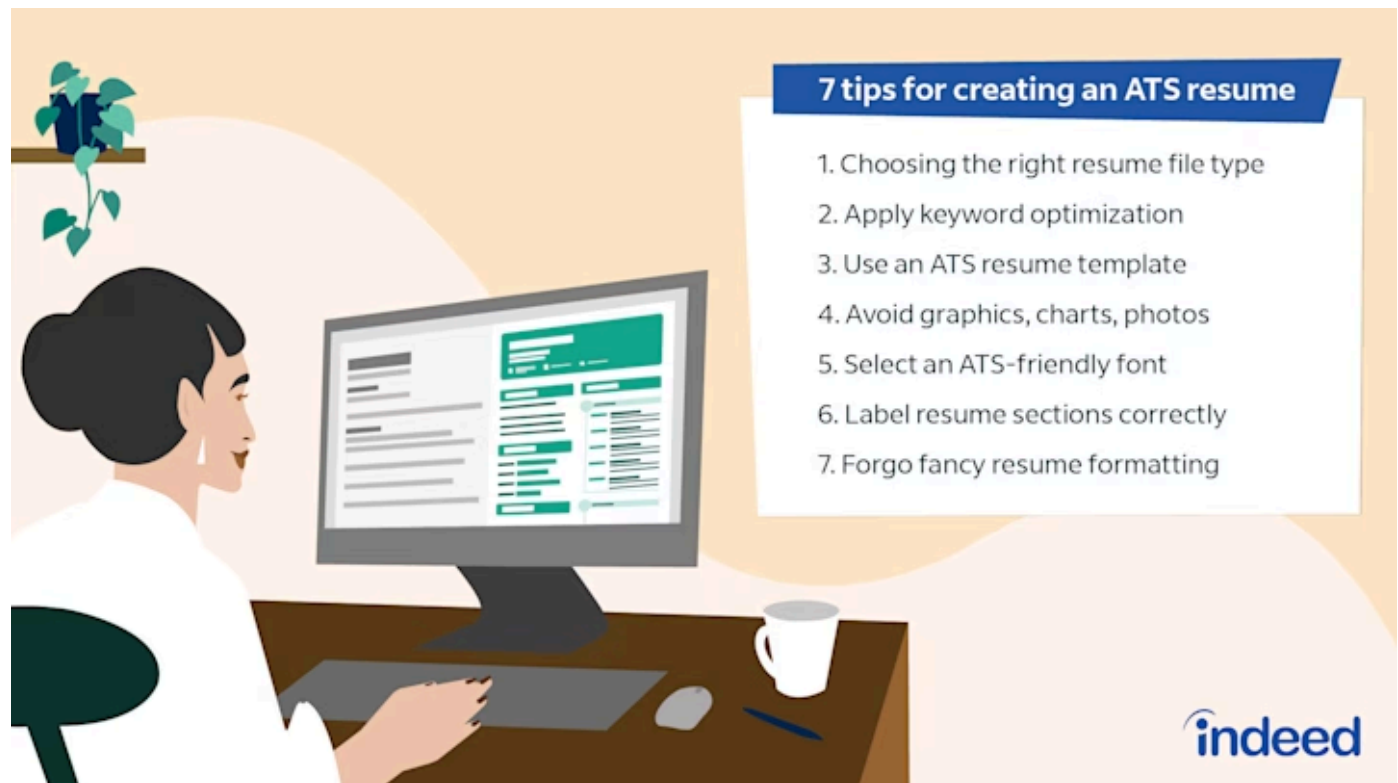
Career Guide

[Resumes & Cover Letters](#) > ATS Resume Format Guide (2025 Template and Example)

ATS Resume Format Guide (2025 Template and Example)

Written by [Indeed Editorial Team](#)

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► Image description

Some hiring managers may use an applicant tracking system (ATS) as a method of organising job applications. Depending on how you write your resume, the ATS may prioritise your job application, which can make it easier for potential employers to notice you. Learning how to write an ATS-friendly resume may help you optimise your job application documents. In this article, we explore how to create an ATS resume format, discover how to use an ATS template,

identify some frequently asked questions about the topic and provide a template and example to help you create your own.

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How to create a resume using an ATS resume format

Writing a resume that conforms to the ATS resume format usually requires several steps. The main purpose of an applicant tracking system is to organise resumes and select candidates that meet job requirements. Large-scale commercial companies that receive many job applications daily typically use application tracking systems. Here's a list of steps you can take to help ensure your resume passes ATS screening:

1. Review the job description

If you're applying for the same position in multiple companies, it's important to remember that potential employers typically search for candidates with unique qualities. Researching each job listing can inform you of the information to focus on when writing your resume. Relating your resume to the role by incorporating keywords contained in the job posting can help ensure your resume passes the initial screening by the ATS.

The keywords selected by employers usually relate to qualifications and requirements necessary for the role. If a hiring manager is searching for a candidate with a bachelor's degree in accounting, then a keyword might be 'bachelor's degree in accounting'. The more keywords

the ATS identifies on your resume, the more highly ranked your application may score by the system.

2. Use correct headings

The applicant tracking system doesn't always register all resume formats. The design of most ATS systems enables them to register the use of headings, which makes it easier for the ATS to process information. Headings may also be a great way to incorporate any specific keywords. Because the ATS is a computerised system, simple formatting and correct headings usually help the system in reviewing your application.

If a potential employer is searching for candidates with certain qualifications but uses the term 'academic achievements' on the job posting, then you can consider that as a heading, instead of 'qualifications.' Some ATS systems translate the data on your resume into its own formatting. If you have used correct headings, then the ATS can more easily create a simple and clear resume for employers to review.

Related: [How to Write a Skills-Based Resume](#) 

3. Keep it simple

If your resume is simple and has clear formatting, then the chances of your resume reaching an employer might increase. ATS systems can often have difficulties when translating complex displays of information, such as columns, tables and charts. The method you can use to keep your formatting simple is using bullet points, short headings and informative sentences. Keeping your sentences short and focused can reduce unnecessary text and help the readability of your document. Try to display your information in short and clear sentences, such as when you describe your responsibilities at a prior job or the key skills that make you suited for the role.

4. Save several resumes

You may be able to use your resume for several job applications, but be sure that the information is applicable to each role and company. Instead of changing the entire document, you can keep the structure and headings of your original copy and adapt the content of certain sections to the requirements in each listing to fulfil employer requirements.

For example, if an employer is searching for candidates with extensive leadership qualities, you may focus your skills section on your leadership abilities and experience. It may also be beneficial to mention responsibilities at previous jobs that involved or required leadership.

Preparing yourself by writing multiple resumes and saving them for re-purposing can help you create a targeted and concise document that explains all of your certifications and skills without the need for a lot of time spent creating each new application.

Related: [What Are Applicant Tracking Systems? The Ultimate Guide](#) 

How to use an ATS resume template

There are several ATS systems that may process resumes differently or favour specific templates. Here's a list of steps you can take to help you create a resume that is read easily by ATS to help increase your chances of passing the screening:

1. Include your contact information

In this section, you can provide your full name, address, phone number and email address. The heading 'contact details' is common for this section and it's likely an ATS can recognize and register it. It's often a good idea to display your contact information at the top of your resume to ensure potential employers can easily contact you.

2. Write a resume objective

After your contact information, you can add one to two sentences explaining your main qualifications, skills and education. If you're applying for an entry-level position and are new to the workforce, you might have little work experience and qualifications. If this is the case, you can use the resume objective to describe your personality and goals to help demonstrate why you make a good employee.

3. Mention your education or certifications

You can include an education and certifications section to outline your qualifications. In this section, you can describe the institution name, your program dates and the degrees or certifications you have completed. If you haven't obtained tertiary education, you can include your high school information. Some jobs may require the completion of year 12, so a keyword to use for these instances include '*year 12*' or '*completion of year 12*'.

4. Add your relevant experience

Next, it's important to mention your role title, the name of the company, date of employment and your typical responsibilities of your previous experience. If you're applying for your first

job, you may include activities that have transferable skills or similar duties. To display your related tasks and duties in a simple format, consider using bullet points in this section.

5. Highlight your skills

Once you have added your relevant experience, you can create a skills section to outline your capabilities and expertise. There are typically several keywords that you can include in the skills section. For example, if a potential employer is searching for a candidate with 'good organisational abilities,' you may incorporate organisation as one of your primary skills to help meet the ATS requirement.

Frequently asked questions about ATS

Here's a list of frequently asked questions for you to review if you are interested in learning more about resumes and ATS:

Is an ATS resume evaluated by a person?

At first, an applicant tracking system typically processes resume applications. If the ATS scans your resume and ranks it high amongst other candidates, then a human is likely to view the document. Because of this, it's important to include factual information and have a simple sentence structure a person can review with ease.

Related: [139 Action Verbs to Make Your Resume Stand Out](#) 

What companies use an ATS system?

Large companies that receive an abundance of job applications often utilise an ATS system to help reduce the cost and time spent reviewing resumes. Smaller businesses may also use an ATS system, though they tend to not benefit as much as large businesses. The primary goal of an employer using an ATS system is usually to review a vast amount of applications in a short period.

ATS resume template

Here's an example of an ATS resume template to help you create your own resume:

Contact details

[Full name]

[Address]

[Phone number]

[Email address]

Objective

[One to two sentences describing your major goals and achievements]

Academics

[Name of the educational institution]

[Dates attended]

[Degrees completed]

Experience

[Job title]

[Company name]

[Dates of employment]

[Responsibilities in bullet point formatting]

Primary skills

[Relevant skills in bullet point formatting]

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Let employers find you when you create an Indeed Resume

ATS resume example

Here's an example of a resume that's created with goals of passing ATS screening for a position as a geologist at a large scale mining company:

Contact details

Sal Atkin

21 South Road

Northing, WA 5041

+613 4567 5644

Atkin@email.com.au

Resume objective

Qualified geologist with five years of experience working in the mining industry. I am applying

for the role of a senior exploration geologist to apply my skills and further my knowledge in geological principles.

Job experience

Exploration geologist

Earth Resource, WA

February 2015–2019

- *Conducting safety meetings*
- *Analysing rock properties*
- *Creating 3D models*
- *Managing drill teams*
- *Conducting XRF scans*
- *Handling cutting machinery*
- *Determining the orientation of cored rock*

Exploration geologist

Geology Co, WA

June 2019–present

- *Managing diamond core drill teams*
- *Liaising with clients*
- *Discussing resource strategies*
- *Analysing magnetic properties*
- *Conducting seismic activities*
- *Determining ore deposit locations*
- *Mapping rock fractures*

Educational achievements

North University, WA

January 2011–2014

- *Completed an applied geology honours major*

Technical skills

- *3D mapping*
- *Mapmaking programs*
- *Environmental regulations*
- *Data management tools*
- *Awareness of health and safety*

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